

OAKLAND

Oakland County votes to pilot Flock surveillance drones amid backlash

Oakland County approved a 9-month Flock drone pilot despite hours of public opposition over privacy, surveillance, and potential costs.



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The Oakland County Sheriff's Office will pilot controversial drones through Flock Group after the Oakland County Board of Commissioners approved the program 13-4 at a contentious meeting on Wednesday, April 8.

The vote was followed by hours of public comment opposing the move.

At the beginning of the meeting, which started at least 30 minutes late, the board voted to move public comment to the end of the meeting. The move was met with minutes of booing from the meeting room packed with Oakland County residents, who would later spend hours commenting in opposition to Flock Drones. Commissioner Charlie Cavell asked the board to perform an exact count of how many commissioners approved. Chair David Woodward said the "yays" won without a roll call vote.